

Betrothy: Friends and Family Investment Memo

An invitation to invest early in Betrothy. It is written for people who know and trust the founder, so it is honest about both the upside and the very real risk.

Important: This is not an offer to sell securities, and it is not legal, tax, or financial advice. Any investment would be made only through signed legal documents (see [the agreement template](#) and [the equity explainer](#)), and you should consult your own lawyer and accountant first. All dollar figures and terms below marked with brackets [] are placeholders to be finalized.

1. The short version

Betrothy is the home for your love story. From the spark, through the wedding, into happily ever after, it gives couples and the people around them the tools (AI planning, a custom song, the ring and gown studios, the wedding website, registry) and the community to bring their love to life. “This could be your love story.”

We are raising a **\$150,000 friends-and-family round** to bring Betrothy into its first market. We would love for the people who believe in us to own a piece of it.

Full detail is in [market-research.md](#) and [investor-onepager.md](#).

2. Why this, why now

- **The category is fragmented and transactional.** Couples stitch together a dozen apps; the tools forget them the moment the wedding ends. Nobody owns the whole love story in a warm, personal way.
- **Couples now demand personalization** (roughly 73% reject template weddings), and AI finally makes a personal, conversational planning experience and custom creative studios real.
- **The wedding is a perfect wedge:** high intent, high spend (the average US wedding is in the low-to-mid 30k USD range), and a hard date.

- **The growth engine is built in:** every wedding brings about a hundred people into a love story, and they become the next couples and guests.

3. What Betrothy includes

Betrothy brings together an AI planning agent (web and a native iOS app), custom-song, ring, and gown studios, wedding microsites with registry and guests, a vendor marketplace, messaging and community, a credits-and-billing system with an AI-cost and margin dashboard, and Google and Apple sign-in. We also have researched, differentiated go-to-market paths through the **church** (reaching couples through marriage ministries and the pastors who marry them) and the **African diaspora**.

4. Who is building it

Andrew Akuaku earned his Master of Information Management and Systems from UC Berkeley's School of Information in May 2026. His final research project studied how Gen Z engages with AI in dating and romance, and what makes a connection feel authentic rather than transactional. That research is the foundation for Betrothy, a product built to help couples build toward marriage and a lasting life together, not to gamify it.

5. How the business makes money

1. **AI credits** (packs from 5 to 20 USD, or 15 USD per month), billed at about 2x our cost, roughly 50% gross margin.
2. **Registry cash gifts** (a small platform fee).
3. **Vendor marketplace** (subscriptions and featured placement, then a booking take-rate over time).

6. The ask and the terms

- **We are raising:** \$150,000 total in this round (about 15% of the company at the cap).
- **Instrument:** a **SAFE** (Simple Agreement for Future Equity), the standard, founder-and-investor-friendly instrument created by Y Combinator. You give the company money now and receive equity later, when we raise our next priced round. See [equity-and-cap-table.md](#) for exactly how the math works.

- **Valuation cap:** \$1,000,000 post-money. In simple terms, your ownership when the SAFE converts is roughly **your investment divided by the cap**. Example: a \$10,000 investment at a \$1,000,000 cap is about **1%** of the company (before future dilution). The lower cap is deliberate, so early friends get more ownership for their money.
- **Minimum check:** [\$500] (and larger checks are welcome).
- **Discount (optional):** [none, or e.g. 20%].

These terms are a starting point and are not final until documented and signed.

7. Where the money goes (use of funds)

Use	Rough share
Go-to-market in the first metro (vendor onboarding, concierge couples)	[40%]
Product and AI costs (the studios, the agent, infrastructure)	[30%]
Church and diaspora launch partnerships	[15%]
Legal, compliance, and operations	[15%]

This round is meant to prove the community growth loop in one market and reach the milestones that support a larger priced round.

8. The risks (please read this part carefully)

Investing in an early-stage startup is **high risk**. Be honest with yourself before you invest:

- **You could lose your entire investment.** Most startups fail. Only invest money you can afford to lose completely.
- **It is illiquid.** You cannot easily sell this. Your money may be locked up for many years, possibly forever.
- **No guaranteed return, dividends, or timeline.** A SAFE only converts to equity if and when we raise a priced round or get acquired. That may never happen.

- **Dilution.** Future fundraising will reduce everyone's percentage ownership.
- **It could strain our relationship.** Money between friends is sensitive. Please only invest an amount that will not change how you feel about me if it goes to zero.

I would rather you invest a comfortable amount, or nothing at all, than risk our friendship or your financial security.

9. The legal bit (securities law)

Selling equity is regulated. A real raise must comply with securities laws (in the US, typically through an exemption such as Regulation D, often limited to **accredited investors**, with specific rules for non-accredited investors). We will run this round properly, with a securities attorney, and you will receive formal documents. Nothing here is an offer; it is an early conversation.

10. How to invest, if you want to

1. Tell me you are interested and roughly how much.
2. I will share the finalized terms and the signed legal documents (the SAFE) once our attorney has them ready.
3. You review them (ideally with your own advisor), sign, and send funds.
4. You receive a countersigned SAFE for your records, and you are officially an early backer of Betrothy.

Timeline: we hope to close this round by [date].

11. Thank you

Betrothy exists to help people build the most important thing in their lives: love that lasts. If you want to be part of that from the very beginning, I would be honored to have you. Either way, thank you for believing in me.

Contact: Andrew Akuaku, andrewakuaku@berkeley.edu, [phone].

This memo is for discussion among friends and family only. It is not an offer or solicitation to buy or sell any security, and it is not legal, tax, accounting, or investment advice. Forward-looking statements are uncertain. Consult your own professional advisors before investing.